

07 BLOCK THAT THOUGHT

Preparing the mind for hard work.

SEASON

1

WEEK

7

FOCUS

CONFIDENCE

KEY PHRASE

“I am enough.”

SUMMARY

This practice focuses on positive thinking and applying it to effort. The coach explains that a positive mindset is mental preparation for hard work, then runs the Block That Thought activity, where teams take a scenario with a negative thinking trap and flip it into a positive thought. Training introduces the roll, technique, a reaction drill, and a no-contact roll-then-combo partner drill, then adds the roll between combinations on the mitts.

MATERIALS

- Mitts & gloves
- Jump ropes
- Scenario cards
- Cones
- Writing utensils · for the scenario cards

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

Practice positive thinking and apply it to their effort



COACH MESSAGE

15 MIN

SAY

The past few weeks have been about being prepared for practice, how you sleep and eat so you can work hard and give full effort. Those are physical ways to prepare your body. We also need to prepare our minds for hard work and challenges.

When the workout is hard and our arms are tired, it's easy to think “I want to stop, my arms hurt so bad.” But we can change that thought into something more positive. Can anyone give me an example of a better thought that would help me keep going? [Gather responses.]

SAY

Imagine two fighters stepping into the ring today. In a real fight, each fighter has people in her corner giving her advice. We're going to do an activity that mimics that and practices positive thoughts.

ACTIVITY · BLOCK THAT THOUGHT Directions

1. Divide the group into two teams: red and blue.
2. Each team sends its fighter to the middle of the ring.
3. Give them a scenario card, then send them back to their corner.
4. Teams write a positive thought on the back and return to the center.
5. Teams share what they came up with.
6. Repeat with the next scenario.

SCENARIO CARDS

- 1 A fighter got four hours of sleep the night before a match because she stayed on her phone late.
"I barely slept last night, I'm going to lose."
THINKING TRAP · CATASTROPHIZING
- 2 The fighter's opponent is two grades older than her.
"There is no way I am going to win."
THINKING TRAP · FORTUNE-TELLING
- 3 A fighter messed up in round 2 and believes she will mess up round 3.
"Since I messed up in round 2, I'm definitely going to do badly in round 3."
THINKING TRAP · OVERGENERALIZING
- 4 A fighter arrives at practice without wraps and has to borrow a teammate's.
"My mom didn't put my wraps in my bag, so it's her fault if I do badly today, not mine."
THINKING TRAP · BLAMING

INTENTIONS**5 MIN****SAY**

Today's guiding question: what do you intend to say to yourself today when things are hard or challenging?

*Every fighter shares out loud. There is no journal this week, these are thoughts to say to the team, not to write. End each intention with **snap clap**.*

TRAINING

30 MIN

ROLL TECHNIQUE New skill

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder.
- Watch the roll video, or explain the roll yourself.
- Start with feet shoulder-width apart.
- Squat down and tap the right hand to the right foot, scooping it over to the left foot.
- Use your legs to drop your body down, do not bend your back.
- Repeat on the other side, then switch to boxing stance and continue.
- Shift weight from foot to foot to complete the scoop, hand back by the face.

WATCH OUT

- Don't look down.
- Don't drop your hands.

SIMON SAYS Roll on call

- Fighters stand in stance, hands up.
- Call **roll** and fighters roll in response, then reset.
- Mix **roll** in with punch calls so fighters have to react, not anticipate.
- Speed up as the group gets clean.

ROLL-THEN-COMBO PARTNER DRILL No contact

- Fighters pair up and choose offense and defense.
- Offense throws 3s and 4s slowly while defense rolls underneath.
- Defense answers with her own two-punch combination after each roll.
- Start slow, then speed up as the partner masters it. Switch roles.

WATCH OUT

Fighters roll in the direction of the punch, not away from it.

MITT WORK · ROLL BETWEEN COMBOS 4 rounds

- Explain the mitt holder's movement that makes the boxer roll.
- **Round 1:** roll (left) · 3 · 2 · predictable
- **Round 2:** roll (right) · 2 · 3 · predictable
- **Round 3:** 6 · 3 · 2 · roll · 2
- **Round 4:** same combination as round 3, thrown with no set cadence. Fighters fall into a rhythm on their own, so break it: vary the gaps and make her react to the mitts, not to a count in her head.
- Switch roles.

☐ BURNOUT · JUMP ROPE

7 MIN

- Five rounds of jump rope: 30 seconds on, 15 seconds rest.
- A tangled rope is not a stop, hand it back and keep going.
- Fighters who finish cheer on the ones still working.

☐ SHOUT-OUTS

3 MIN

- Ask the group: what did you see our team do that helped us get to our goal?
- Fighters share shout-outs, each ending with **snap clap**.